Yeltsin made a formal declaration of the end of the Cold War and to beginning of a new era of relationship between the United States and the Russian Federation. After intense talks at Camp David in February 1992, the two leaders signed a declaration, which sought to highlight the new relationship based on trust and commitment to economic and political freedom. In June 1992, Yeltsin and Bush signed the "Washington Charter" and six other documents relating to economic, scientific and military cooperation between the two.[19] Therefore, decades of hostility, antagonism and suspicion ended and paved way for post-Cold War development in the relation between the US and the Russian Federation and changes in the international system in the post-Cold War era.

End of Cold War

Gorbachev's *new thinking* reflected in his **glasnost** (openness) and **perestroika** (political and economic restructuring) unleashed such forces which ultimately became the reason of destruction of the Soviet Union. Internally, there were several reasons which led to the collapse of communism. Richard Crockatt pointed out some long- and short-term causes which included structural weaknesses in the economy, inflexible planning system, inability to modernize; economic stagnation; poor harvest and ironically, Gorbachev's glasnost and perestroika also contributed to the disintegration of the Soviet Union. The last one heavily damaged the existence of the Soviet Union as it undermined the role of the Communist party and also loosened the control over media which made the public opinion out of control of Gorbachev. Following the elections of 1989, a number of communist candidates were defeated and there took place "a whirlwind of free debate that scattered every known communist taboo".[20] This was coupled with the demand for independence and secessionist movements which finally led to the crumbling of the Soviet Union. In reality, Gorbachev underestimated the task of changing the Soviet Union overnight. This led to policy errors and contributed to the failure of his programme of resurrecting socialism built on the foundation of successful implementation of **perestroika** and **demokratzatsiya.**[21]